

What other centers asked us for

A menu to react to — not a prescription. These are things **other APEX / SBDC counselors and their funders** told us they struggled with and wanted. You'll have your own ideas; this is here to trigger the ones you haven't thought of yet. Each is marked **live today** or **proposed** so you know what you can use Monday vs. what we'd build with you.

LIVE

In Mindy today — usable now

PROPOSED

Asked for by others — we'd build it

WHAT COUNSELORS TOLD US THEY STRUGGLE WITH

Verbatim themes from an APEX center that scoped this with us (the pattern repeats across centers).

“Clients attend training but don't complete the actions — we can't see where they drop off.”

Live: a workspace per client shows exactly how far each one got (profile, targets, pipeline).

“Each counselor does things their own way — the knowledge is trapped in people's heads.”

Live: the Knowledge Base makes your center's playbooks searchable for every counselor.

“We spend too much time hunting for templates — everything's scattered across drives.”

Live: load your guidance docs once; ask Mindy instead of digging.

“We can't prove our impact to funders — there's no tracking from activity to outcome.”

Proposed: a monthly engagement + outcomes report built for grant reporting.

HELPS HER → For the counselor

Run every client from one seat

LIVE

Each business is its own workspace — its own pipeline, target agencies, and market research. Search across your whole caseload and "work as" any one of them. Import a whole roster in one paste.

Every center that saw this wanted it first — it's the core of Coach Mode.

Your playbooks, made searchable

LIVE

A private AI over *your* internal guidance docs — "what did we tell construction firms about bonding?" Counselors asked for this by name ("Custom AI Workbench").

Resonated most in the original quote: "private AI on THEIR documents, not generic."

See where each client stalls

LIVE

The client list shows how far each business got — so you know who to nudge and who's ready, instead of guessing from memory.

Answers "we can't see where clients drop off."

Task & milestone tracking per client

PROPOSED

Assign and track the concrete next steps for each business (SAM done, cap statement drafted, first bid submitted) — a checklist that rolls up across your caseload.

Explicitly requested: "task/milestone tracking," "activity dashboards."

Assign counselors to clients

PROPOSED

An admin view to assign each business to a specific counselor and see each counselor's book of clients — for centers with a team, not a solo.

Needed once more than one counselor is in the account.

Standardize the "how we do it"

PROPOSED

Documented playbooks + templates baked into the workspace so every counselor works the same way — the fix for "knowledge trapped in people's heads."

Requested as "playbook documentation."

HELPS HER COMMUNITY → For the small businesses she serves

Daily opportunity alerts

LIVE

Every client gets matched opportunities by email — free, forever. The volume play: don't miss what fits.

The #1 gap in the original quote — the other vendor didn't include it.

Who's buying + who to call

LIVE

Market research ranks the agencies that actually spend on a client's work, then the buying offices and decision-makers there.

Also missing from the other vendor: "market intelligence, who's buying."

Bid help + compliance matrix

LIVE

Bid/no-bid scoring, every "shall" pulled into a matrix, a drafted first response, and a .docx export — so a client's first bid isn't a blank page.

Maps to their "Proposal Response Basics" client journey.

Recompetes + forecasts + teaming

LIVE

What's expiring (recompete targets), what's coming (forecasts), and who to team with (contractor database) — all missing from the other quote.

The full "what they didn't include" list — MI fills it.

Guided client journeys (structured paths, not a blank tool)

PROPOSED

Other centers asked for step-by-step paths a client walks on their own. Mindy already has three (profile → find customers → first bid); centers asked for these five:

A

New Entrant Readiness

SAM → compliance → capability statement

B

Set-Aside Path

WOSB / HUBZone cert → targeting

C

CMMC Level 1 Readiness

Cyber baseline for DoD work

D

Proposal Basics

First response, done right
(live)

E

Subcontracting Match

Find a prime to team with

The exact 5 journeys an APEX center scoped. D exists today; the rest we'd build.

HELPS HER FUNDERS → For the grant / funder story

Monthly engagement & outcomes report

PROPOSED

The one every center circled: an automatic report showing clients served, actions completed, opportunities pursued, and contracts won — the activity-to-outcome trail funders ask for. Today Mindy captures the underlying activity (signups, profile completion, app usage, pipeline); the funder-ready report is the packaging on top.

Requested as "monthly report on client engagement — data for their grants."

White-label as NCMBC's own

PROPOSED

Your name, your logo, your colors — the tool presents as NCMBC's platform, not a third party. Reports go out white-labeled too.

Enterprise "white-label reports" — asked for by centers pitching their board.

Drop-off & ROI dashboard

PROPOSED

Where clients stall, conversion from training to action, and outcomes — the numbers that prove the center is working, at a glance.

Directly answers "no tracking of activity → outcomes."

The funder angle is the wedge. Every center said the same thing: they can deliver help all day, but they can't *prove* it to the people who fund them. Whoever solves the reporting story becomes indispensable — this is the feature most likely to unlock budget. Worth asking NCMBC what her funder actually requires in a report.

Questions to spark her own ideas

- ? What does your **funder** actually require you to report — and how do you produce it today?
- ? Where do **most clients stall**? (If we could surface that automatically, would it change how you counsel?)
- ? If your **whole team** could see every client's status in one place, what would that change?
- ? Which of your **own playbooks** would be most valuable to make searchable for every counselor?
- ? Of the five client journeys — which does **your community** need most? (New entrant? Set-aside? CMMC?)

Live = usable Monday · Proposed = requested by other centers, built with you · sources: APEX Illinois scoping + community BD plan